

USER HANDBOOK & DAILY GUIDE



THOLA.

How to Use the THOLA Platform

A simple, everyday guide written for buyers, service providers, and local tradespeople to run their daily marketplace activities safely.

Version: 1.0 (Official User Guide)

THOLA Community Trade Network. Built on Safety and Verified Trust.

1. Accessing & Discovering THOLA

PLATFORM ENTRY

Purpose: This is the digital storefront. It introduces how the trust-based trading system operates and lets you sign in or read about verification before starting.

VISUAL ELEMENTS & BUTTONS

Theme Toggle Switch (🌞 / 🌙) VISUAL MODE CONTROL

Located in the top right corner of the navigation bar.

What it does: Toggles the application between Light and Dark mode. Useful for browsing comfortably at night or in bright sun.

"Get Started" / "Join Today" Buttons ACTION TRIGGER

Prominent orange buttons located on the home screen banner.

What it does: Takes you immediately to the signup form so you can build your profile and publish list items.

"Learn More" Section INFORMATION LINK

Link under the main title describing security details.

What it does: Takes you to a page detailing how the biometrics validation check and vouch systems keep your money and identity safe.

2. Creating Your Profile & Caching Session

[LOGIN & REGISTER](#)

Purpose: Creating a safe account locks in your identity and links active vouchers directly to your listing posts.

SIGN UP / REGISTER SCREEN

User Details Form (Name, Email, Password)

[REGISTRATION FORM](#)

Basic fields to establish your profile.

How to use: Fill in your everyday contact information. The system ensures passwords match before allowing you to sign up.

"Create Account" Button

[SUBMIT ACTION](#)

Green submission button underneath the form fields.

What happens: Automatically registers your details, saves your account, starts your session, and logs you into the dashboard instantly.

SIGN IN / LOG IN SCREEN

"Log In" Button

[ACCESS TRIGGER](#)

Validates email/password credentials to let you back in.

What happens: Confirms your account matches the registered password. On success, it opens the dashboard. If incorrect, it flags the issue with a notification.

3. Navigating the Marketplace

MARKETPLACE DASHBOARD

Purpose: This is the daily marketplace grid. From here you can query local skills, physical goods, and filter items by location.

DAILY BROWSING & FILTERING

Search Input Box TEXT LOOKUP

The search field at the top of the dashboard page.

How to use: Type keywords (e.g. "cleaning" or "plumbing"). The grid automatically narrows down listings in real-time.

Province Dropdown Menu LOCATION FILTER

Select box representing all 9 South African provinces.

How to use: Select your home province (e.g., *Gauteng*). The page hides items that are located outside your province.

Marketplace listing card ITEM PREVIEW

Renders thumbnail image, title, pricing, location, and rating badge.

What happens: Clicking a card saves the item detail reference and loads the full product page.

4. Service Details & Adding Listings

[DETAIL VIEW & POST LISTING](#)

Purpose: Evaluate details, check provider trust, and post services or goods to make them instantly discoverable.

READING & COMMUNICATING ON LISTING DETAILS

"Contact Provider" Button [CHAT ACTION](#)

Orange highlighted action button on the sidebar of listing details.

What happens: Reads the provider's details, links your session together, and opens the live chat interface.

POSTING A NEW LISTING

Listing Form Details (Title, Category, Price, Image) [LISTING CREATOR](#)

Input fields to describe what you are offering to the community.

How to use: Enter listing title, choose a category, pick your province from the dropdown, upload a picture URL, and press **Publish** to launch it live on the marketplace.

5. Chatting & Building Profile Trust

CHAT & PROFILES

Purpose: Communicate securely with buyers/sellers and complete verification steps to display trust badges next to your name.

CHATTING WITH CUSTOMERS

Contacts Sidebar List CONVERSATION HUB

List of client profiles you have chatted with.

How to use: Click a client's name to view message history logs and write back.

Message Box & Send Trigger MESSAGE INPUT

Typing bar at the bottom of the chat viewport.

How to use: Type a message and press **Send**. It instantly pushes the text to the client and logs it in your active conversation history.

PROFILE TRUST BADGES

"Verify Identity" / "Face Match" Actions IDENTITY VALIDATION

Actions inside your profile dashboard to establish authenticity.

How to use: Upload ID cards or scan face parameters. The system sets your badges to active. This displays the security checkmark badge on all listings you publish.

6. Step-by-Step Daily Routine Walkthrough

[USER FLOW MAP](#)

Follow this step-by-step layout for a typical daily transaction sequence on the platform.

1 Browse Local Listings

Go to your dashboard. Select your home province (e.g. *Gauteng*) and select whether you are searching for services or physical items to filter the listings grid.

2 Evaluate Trust Verification

Click on the listing card. Check the seller's verified flags—check if they have completed biometric face match checks and read the community ratings.

3 Negotiate & Arrange Delivery

Press "**Contact Provider**" to start a chat. Message the seller to agree on dynamic pricing and arrange local pickup or scheduling details.

4 Vouch to Boost Reputations

Once you successfully finish a trade, navigate back to the seller's profile page and submit a vouch to increment their trust rating in the local ecosystem.